SABLE MERIDIAN

Beginner's User Manual

Trade Charter / Current Recovery Build

Learn one trip at a time.

A practical guide to buying cargo, choosing a destination, completing deliveries, handling trouble, and deciding when to end a career.

This manual follows the current playable build, including career ranks, lasting market events, faction relationships, insurance, rescue loans, and the GAME menu.
Examples describe choices you can practice. Market offers, missions, and encounters vary between games. Always read the current offer before acting.

No formulas, probability tables, or internal game calculations. The focus is on the steps you take and the results you should look for.
Prepared October 5, 2026

Your Reading Route

Read chapters 1-6 for your first trading trip and delivery. Return to the later chapters when you need those features.

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The everyday loop

Check the ship. Choose cargo or a contract. Buy what you need. Travel. Sell or deliver. Refuel and repair. Then choose the next trip.

For a quiet first session, leave smuggling, ambitious event trades, and risky destinations for later. Learn the purchase, journey, and sale sequence first.

01 Start Your First Career

Begin with a small legal trade. You do not need to learn every feature before you play.

1. Open the current game in your browser. A fresh captain starts docked at ASTERION. If an older charter appears, you are seeing saved progress rather than a new game.

2. To start fresh, choose GAME in the lower-right corner, then Start New Game. Read the confirmation and choose Confirm New Game. This replaces the current saved charter. Choose Cancel to keep it.

3. Open CAREER before your first journey. Choose a short fixed-term career, a longer fixed-term career, or Endless. The fixed terms are labeled 100 jumps and 200 jumps. Endless has no scheduled retirement. A fresh game begins with the shorter fixed term selected.

4. Open MARKET. For the first trip, choose ordinary cargo such as Nickel Ore or Water Ice. Leave restricted goods and smuggling until you are comfortable with travel and selling.

5. Keep some money unspent. Fuel, repairs, insurance premiums, and encounter choices can all require cash. Buying the largest possible load is not automatically the best choice.

Example
Your first goal: buy a small amount of Nickel Ore, travel to another port, and sell it if the offer is worthwhile. Treat this as a practice trip rather than a guaranteed profitable route.

Before leaving: choose your career term, check fuel, buy only what you intend to carry, and leave a cash reserve. Changing tabs does not make a journey or advance a deadline.

02 Find Your Way Around

Use the tabs as work areas. The GAME button remains available even when an encounter interrupts your trip.

MARKET is where you buy and sell. MANIFEST shows what is actually in your hold. MAP lets you choose a destination and buy fuel. MISSIONS contains available offers and accepted contracts.

INTEL reports active market events and faction relationships. UPGRADES contains ship improvements and hull repairs. CAREER shows promotion progress, the chosen term, and retirement options. STATUS brings together ship condition, insurance, recovery, and save controls.

1. Read the current planet name before acting. It tells you where you are docked. Selecting a different tab does not move the ship.

2. Check the top display for available money, occupied cargo space, ship condition, and fuel. Use these as practical warnings; there is no need to work out any calculations.

3. Look at TRADE NET - LOG after an action. It reports purchases, sales, travel, encounter outcomes, and reasons an action could not proceed. It is especially useful when a button seems to do nothing.

4. On a phone or narrow window, slide the tab row sideways to reach tabs that are off-screen. Wide market rows can also require horizontal scrolling. Scroll down within the page to reach lower controls.

Example
You open MISSIONS and accept a delivery, then switch to MANIFEST. The hold is still empty. Accepting a contract records the job; it does not supply its goods.

GUIDE opens a short in-game reference. GAME opens Retire Captain, Quit Game, Start New Game, and Back to Game. CLEAR in the log clears messages, not cargo or the saved charter.

03 Buy Your First Cargo

Start with a small purchase so you can see each action clearly.

1. Open MARKET and click a category heading to reveal its goods. RAW / ENERGY is a useful starting point for ordinary materials. Expand All and Collapse All change which groups are visible.

2. Find a commodity. In its row, B is the price you pay to buy it, S is the price the port offers to buy it from you, and H is the amount you hold. The buy and sell offers are different.

3. Choose TRADE... on that row. Its small menu offers Buy 1, Buy 5, and a Max option. Max buys as much as your money and free hold space allow; it can leave you short of emergency cash.

4. Choose Buy 1 for a cautious test, or Buy 5 for a small load. If you need a quantity that is not a menu choice, use the small purchases repeatedly. For example, Buy 5 followed by Buy 1 buys six units when funds and space permit.

5. Open MANIFEST and confirm that the item appears. Check the log if the purchase was limited or refused. Close the trade menu using its close button when finished.

Example
Practice purchase: expand RAW / ENERGY, find Nickel Ore, open TRADE..., and choose Buy 5 once. In MANIFEST, verify that you have Nickel Ore before planning your journey.

Restricted goods are marked differently from ordinary cargo. Holding them may expose you to police action. Begin with legal goods; a high potential selling price does not remove the risks of carrying contraband.

If a commodity disappears, turn off Profitable only and expand its category. That filter helps narrow the list, but it is not the complete market.

04 Choose a Port and Travel

A jump is a journey to another port. Selecting a destination starts the trip; it is not just a preview.

1. Open MAP. Read the destination cards before clicking one. They show local conditions, law enforcement, pirate danger, fuel requirements, faction affiliation, and any lasting market event.

2. Check that you have enough fuel for the selected destination. Refueling controls are available in MAP and STATUS. Choose a small refill, a larger refill, or MAX, keeping an eye on your remaining money.

3. Choose a destination with lower displayed pirate danger for your practice trip. MIRRORGLASS is one possible destination from ASTERION, but no route guarantees safe passage or a profit.

4. Click the destination card to travel. If an encounter appears, make a choice before expecting to arrive. If travel is refused, read the log and address the reason it gives.

5. After arrival, check the current planet name. Then open MARKET and examine the actual offers. Mission deadlines and lasting event durations move forward when an arrival is completed.

Example
You carry Nickel Ore and have enough fuel for MIRRORGLASS. Choose its map card. If pirates interrupt, resolve the encounter. Only after the current planet reads MIRRORGLASS should you treat its market as your destination market.

The numbered QUICK TRAVEL buttons also begin journeys. Their labels and hover information identify destinations. They are convenient once you know the map, but destination cards are easier for a beginner to review.

Fuel is spent when you attempt a jump, even if pirates interrupt it. Opening a tab, reading Intel, or pausing the game does not advance the world.

05 Sell Cargo and Repeat

Selling turns your carried goods back into usable money. Compare the offer before committing.

1. At the new port, open MARKET and find the item you brought. Confirm that H shows you still hold it. The MANIFEST is another way to check your cargo.

2. Look at the profit indication for that item. It helps you see whether selling your held cargo now would produce a gain or a loss. No manual calculation is required.

3. Open TRADE... and choose Sell 1 or Sell 5 for a partial sale, or the All option to sell the entire held quantity. The menu shows the available quantity.

4. Read the sale message in the log. Reopen MANIFEST to confirm the goods were reduced or removed. With a rescue loan outstanding, some sale proceeds automatically repay it.

5. Decide what to do next: buy a different item, complete a contract, refuel, repair, or leave with an empty hold. There is no requirement to carry a full load on every journey.

Example
You arrive with five Nickel Ore. If the current offer gives a profit, choose Sell 5 and confirm that the hold is cleared. If the offer is poor, you can carry it onward, sell only part, or accept the loss to free space. None of these choices guarantees a better future price.

NAME sorts the market by item name. PROFIT helps bring favorable comparisons forward within categories. Profitable only hides some unhelpful rows. Price memory records earlier port offers; it is a reference, not a promise that an earlier price is still available.

Selling an item in MARKET does not complete a mission. If those goods are for a contract, keep the required amount and use COMPLETE in MISSIONS at the destination instead.

06 Complete a Legal Delivery

A mission is a contract for specific goods at a specific destination. You supply the cargo yourself.

1. Open MISSIONS and read an available DELIVERY offer. Identify the commodity, quantity, destination, remaining travel allowance, and sponsor. Pick one that you can afford and reach without a complicated detour.

2. Choose ACCEPT. The contract moves to ACTIVE. Accept only a small number of jobs while learning; several unrelated deliveries can compete for money, hold space, and time.

3. Open MARKET and buy the required goods. If the contract asks for six Micro Reactors, use Buy 5 and then Buy 1. The exact contract in your game may request a different item or quantity.

4. Check MANIFEST, then return to MISSIONS. The active contract shows whether you have enough cargo. Buy only the missing amount if you already hold some of it.

5. Use MAP to reach the named destination. Every completed arrival uses up some of the contract deadline, including detours. Make the delivery before its allowance runs out.

6. At the destination, open MISSIONS and choose COMPLETE. Successful completion removes the required cargo, pays the contract, and records the job. Read the log to confirm it worked.

Example
An offer asks for six Micro Reactors at MIRRORGLASS. You accept, buy six, check the hold, and travel there. At MIRRORGLASS you select COMPLETE, rather than selling the reactors in MARKET.

If COMPLETE is blocked, check the destination and quantity. The log describes the missing step. ABANDON (-1 REP) cancels a job with consequences; expiry also counts as failure. Available offers refresh on arrival, so accept an offer before leaving if you intend to pursue it.

07 Handle Pirates and Police

Encounters interrupt travel. Read the choices shown in the encounter before committing.

Pirates can threaten ordinary cargo as well as contraband. ATTACK attempts to defeat them. EVADE attempts to escape. BRIBE pays for passage when you can afford the displayed price. Fighting or escaping can fail and damage the ship.

1. During a pirate encounter, check the ship condition and cash you have available. Do not assume a button labeled ATTACK or EVADE will succeed.

2. If you choose BRIBE, check its price first. An unaffordable pirate bribe forces a fight in this build. If you choose ATTACK or EVADE, read the outcome in the log.

3. If the ship survives, travel may continue into a police encounter before arrival. If it is destroyed, insurance determines whether the charter can recover.

Police encounters concern carried contraband. COMPLY surrenders the illegal cargo and may cost money. EVADE risks further damage, penalties, and lost cargo. BRIBE can preserve the cargo if accepted, but the payment can be taken even when the attempt fails.

4. For a police encounter, compare the importance of your illegal cargo with the consequences shown. Compliance is not a free exit; evasion and bribery are not guaranteed ways to keep the shipment.

Example
You accepted a smuggling contract and are scanned before reaching its destination. If police seize the shipment, arrival alone will not complete the job. You need to obtain replacement cargo and still meet the deadline, or accept the failed contract.

Smuggling offers may pay more, but accepting them attracts attention. Successful smuggling can also damage relationships with lawful factions. GAME remains available during encounters: you can save and quit or retire without resolving the encounter first.

08 Use Lasting Market Events

Intel lets you plan around conditions that continue for several arrivals instead of treating each port visit in isolation.

1. Open INTEL and read ACTIVE MARKET EVENTS. Each report names the port, affected goods, whether prices are raised or lowered, and how much of the event remains.

2. For a shortage or demand event, consider bringing the named goods from another port. For a surplus event, consider buying the affected goods there and selling them elsewhere.

3. Use MAP to check the route and the event label on the destination card. Compare the time left with the number of arrivals your plan requires. Do not take a long detour for an event about to end.

4. On arrival, inspect MARKET. The local event banner identifies the active condition. Use the actual buy and sell offers to decide whether the trade still makes sense.

Example
INTEL reports a Medical Emergency at BASILICA affecting Trauma Gel and other medical supplies. You already carry Trauma Gel. If the event has enough time left, BASILICA may be worth considering; still check fuel, travel danger, and the selling offer after arrival.

The current event types include Medical Emergency, Supply Blockade, Foundry Surplus, Festival Demand, Record Harvest, and Energy Glut. They affect listed goods, not every item at the port. New events can appear and old ones can end as journeys are completed.

An event with one arrival left ends before the next market opens. Its clock advances even when you visit a different port. Reloading the game, changing tabs, or quitting and resuming does not restart the event. Events create opportunities, not guaranteed profits.

09 Build Faction Relationships

Faction standing is separate from career rank. A respected captain can still be unwelcome to a particular group.

1. Open INTEL and read FACTION RELATIONSHIPS. Each faction lists its associated ports, your standing, and the privileges or disadvantages currently attached to it.

2. Choose legal deliveries to destinations associated with a faction you want to help. Completed deliveries improve that destination faction relationship. Abandoned and expired deliveries damage it.

3. Check the sponsor on a mission. Good standing can improve sponsor payments and local buying terms. Poor standing can make those terms worse. The displayed contract estimate reflects the applicable terms.

4. Review RELATIONSHIP HISTORY after important choices. It records changes caused by contracts, patrol decisions, and developments in the world.

The Federation represents ASTERION and ROOK BASTION. Corporate Houses operate at KARTH FOUNDRY, MIRRORGLASS, and HELIO NINE. The Frontier Compact serves VEGA MIRE, BASILICA, and EDEN VERGE. The Freeport League is associated with NADIR FREEPORT and UMBRA DRIFT.

Example
You complete a delivery to EDEN VERGE and the Frontier Compact relationship improves. Later, you complete a smuggling job: Freeport relations improve, but Federation and corporate relations suffer. A higher overall career rank does not cancel those consequences.

Federation trust reduces police scrutiny, but does not legalize all contraband. Freeport trust can make pirate passage cheaper. Police compliance, evasion, and bribery also influence your Federation relationship.

There is no need to manage every faction at once. For your first career, favor reliable legal deliveries and review the standing labels when choosing your next job. The game preserves these relationships in saves.

10 Maintain and Improve the Ship

Regular maintenance helps protect the career you are building. Upgrades are useful only if you can still afford to operate afterward.

1. After a difficult journey, open STATUS and check ship condition. Hull is the ship itself; shields offer protection but do not make the hull invulnerable. Fuel is what allows the next journey.

2. Open UPGRADES and find REPAIR BAY. Choose REPAIR 1 for a small repair, REPAIR 10 for a larger repair, or REPAIR MAX to restore as much as the controls allow. Watch the log if you cannot afford the requested repair.

3. Refuel through MAP or STATUS. Buy enough for the route you intend to take and keep some cash in reserve. MAX is convenient, but it may spend money you need elsewhere.

4. Once routine expenses are comfortable, choose an upgrade. CARGO creates more hold space. ECO makes travel more economical and helps survivability. WEAPONS improves the ability to fight pirates.

5. Check the displayed purchase price before selecting an upgrade. Buying an improvement changes the ship immediately. It is not a preview or a refundable reservation.

Example
You finish a delivery and now have spare money. First repair damage and prepare fuel for the next trip. If cash remains, a cargo upgrade may let you carry a delivery and a small trading load together. Delay the upgrade if it would leave you unable to refuel.

More valuable cargo can attract pirates, and weapon improvements do not guarantee combat victories. Avoid treating a larger or better-armed ship as permission to stop checking routes and condition.

Career promotions make repairs cheaper. You do not need to work out the discount: use the current price shown in REPAIR BAY. Insurance is a separate choice in STATUS, not a repair or a ship upgrade.

11 Protect Your Career with Insurance

Insurance can preserve a captain after ship destruction, but it does not protect the cargo or every contract.

1. At a port, open STATUS and find SHIP INSURANCE. The switch shows Uninsured or Covered. Read the terms before changing it.

2. Turn the switch on to enroll. Enrollment costs 150cr. If you do not have enough money, the switch is unavailable. Enrollment is not available during an active encounter or after the charter is closed.

3. Keep money available for the 10cr premium after each completed jump. Opening screens and reloading the same arrival do not charge a new premium. If you cannot pay at arrival, coverage lapses.

4. Check STATUS and the log for lapse warnings. Once coverage has lapsed, the ship is uninsured until you enroll again. Switching coverage off cancels it without refunding the enrollment fee.

Example
You enroll before leaving on a delivery. Pirates destroy the ship en route. Insurance recovers it at the departure port in damaged condition, with no shields and enough fuel for the cheapest available jump. Your cargo is gone and active contracts fail, but your career rank and faction relationships are retained.

5. After recovery, read the claim notice in STATUS. The policy has been consumed. Repair the ship, choose whether to enroll again, and plan a smaller recovery trade. Do not expect the interrupted journey to have been completed.

Without active coverage, ship destruction ends the charter. Insurance is optional: the safer-looking route can still produce an encounter, and buying a policy does not make any trade profitable.

An insured loss does not reset your career, but it is still costly. Replacing the lost goods, restoring the ship, and rebuilding your cash reserve become the next tasks.

12 Recover When You Are Stranded

Emergency rescue is offered only when you lack fuel for every other port and cannot afford enough fuel for the cheapest route.

1. Try ordinary refueling first. If you have enough money to buy the missing fuel, use MAP or STATUS. A low tank alone does not qualify for emergency rescue.

2. If both fuel and money are insufficient, open STATUS. EMERGENCY RESCUE appears with a specific loan offer. MAP may also show a stranded notice that opens STATUS.

3. Read the full quote. It covers the missing fuel plus a 200cr rescue fee. There is no upfront payment or interest. Some future income will repay the loan automatically.

4. Choose Accept Rescue Loan only if you want those terms. The ship receives enough fuel for the cheapest route from its current port. Rescue does not make a jump, repair the hull, move the ship, or fill the tank for every destination.

5. Choose a route you can now afford in fuel. Continue with a modest trade or achievable delivery. The remaining loan balance appears in STATUS.

Example
Your ship is docked with an empty tank and no spare cash. You accept the quoted rescue loan. You now have fuel for a nearby route. After selling cargo there, part of the proceeds repays the loan, while the remainder becomes spendable cash.

The game uses 20% of cargo-sale proceeds, contract payments, and salvage income to repay the outstanding balance, stopping once it is paid. This repayment comes from proceeds, so leave room in your plans for operating expenses.

Rescue is not insurance. It addresses a fuel-and-cash shortage; it does not revive an uninsured destroyed ship. The offer disappears once the ship can travel or you can afford the missing fuel.

13 Progress, Retire, Quit, or Start Again

You control when to stop. Retirement and quitting have different effects.

CAREER tracks progress through Independent Trader, Licensed Merchant, Route Captain, Trade Magnate, and Charter Legend. The next-rank checklist shows what remains to be achieved. Promotions are permanent and improve contract terms and repair prices.

1. To continue a career, trade, visit new ports, and complete contracts. Review CAREER occasionally rather than trying to calculate promotion requirements yourself.

2. To retire, choose GAME, Retire Captain, then Confirm Retirement. You can retire at any time, including before the first journey or during an encounter. Keep Playing cancels the decision.

3. Read the RETIREMENT REPORT. Retirement closes the charter: trading and travel stop. You may export the career save or begin a new charter, but ordinary Resume does not reopen a retired captain.

4. To stop temporarily, choose GAME, Quit Game, then Save and Quit. The game shows Game Closed. Resume Game returns to the same charter. A pending encounter remains part of the saved progress.

5. To replace the current charter, choose GAME, Start New Game, then Confirm New Game. Cancel keeps the current charter. A new game starts with a fresh ship, cargo hold, relationships, and career; it is not an inherited continuation.

Example
You need a break halfway through a pirate encounter. Use Save and Quit, then Resume Game when ready to decide. If you choose retirement instead, the encounter is closed and that captain receives a final report.

Fixed-term careers also retire automatically at the end of their chosen term. Endless has no scheduled retirement. Quit shows a saved pause screen; it does not close the browser window. Export a backup before starting a new game if you want to keep the old charter.

14 Save, Restore, and Solve Common Problems

The game saves automatically, but a separate backup is useful before replacing a charter or changing browsers.

1. Open STATUS and find SAVE / LOAD. MANUAL SAVE NOW saves the current progress on demand. Automatic saving normally handles ordinary play without this extra step.

2. For a backup, choose EXPORT SAVE. The game displays the save text and may copy it to the clipboard. COPY TO CLIPBOARD is also available. Keep the complete text somewhere outside the game for later restoration.

3. To restore, paste the complete backup into the IMPORT SAVE box, then choose LOAD IMPORTED SAVE. Restoring replaces the current charter with the backup, including its career, market events, relationships, insurance, and rescue debt.

4. Read the log for IMPORT OK or a failure message. An invalid or incomplete paste will not produce the expected restoration. Export before trying a different backup if the current charter matters to you.

Example
You want to start a new captain but keep your retired trader. Export the retired career first, preserve the complete backup, then start a new game. Later you can import the old backup to view that retired charter again.

Cannot buy? Check money and free cargo space. Cannot travel? Check fuel, ship condition, and whether the charter is closed. Cannot complete a mission? Check its cargo and exact destination. Missing market row?
Expand the category and turn off Profitable only.

No rescue offer? You may already have enough fuel, be able to afford the shortfall, or have a closed or destroyed charter. No insurance enrollment? You may lack the fee or be in an encounter. A disappointing sale? Arrival prices and events can change; earlier examples are not promised outcomes.

Browser saves belong to the browser environment where you play. A different browser, cleared browser data, or a different location for the game may not show the same save. Use an exported backup to move progress deliberately. On an unfamiliar screen, read the log before repeating actions.